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Siaya

Author(S): Cohen, David William, Atiendo Odhiambo, E. S.

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Elijah tried to change the flow of conversation:

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'We have been under self-control here and we have proceeded by the standards of practice in Alego, but you want us to do it at the same time in the Yimbo way, which is impossible. You raise the question of cattle, but know that that is out because your cows around here are never looked after ... they just roam around the bush and aren't brought home even in two days.'

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The sub-chief responded, 'Can't you see the tethering poles just out there? ... Maybe you don't know the use of those poles. When we settled an Alego family who gave us a girl she told us not to shame her but only to produce what we had.'

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As the sub-chief's wife and Adhiambo started to serve the food, Ochanda remarked that

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'We did not come to eat, if you feel that we are your visitors who are worth providing for, then feed us, but if you feel that we are not worth providing for, then don't feed us. We haven't asked for food, and, after all, since we came here we have seen nobody we recognize as sisters-in-law and mothers-in-law.'

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The food was eaten slowly, with some flirting between the *jogam* and the sisters of Adhiambo and some jokes passed back and forth with the brothers. Drinks were brought and the sub-chief came in again. Ochanda asked for the actual people of Adhiambo to come in ... 'We have something for the uncle and the mother of Adhiambo. We do not want to give it to the sub-chief.' The uncle came in and Ochanda handed him some cash, folded into a tight bundle. The uncle unfolded it, laid it on the table and slowly counted it. 'My friends,' he said, 'They have brought us thirty shillings.' And then he handed it to the sub-chief.

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Ochanda tried to control his anger.

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'We once more thank you for the entertainments we have had since we came here ... I think our visit was not an abrupt one ... we sent proper notice in advance ... and we hope you expected us ... our main aim of coming was to arrange for Adhiambo to go back to her husband. We have come to take Adhiambo and whatever has to be done we will do in the morning and then we will leave. But now we are tired.'

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The sub-chief erupted: 'How can you want Adhiambo, yet since you came here ... you haven't produced a shilling or a calf ... you haven't produced anything to show that you want  107 her ... and then there is the matter of the child ... it

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stays here with Adhiambo and is fed by us.' The father of the subchief added, 'The small thing that you have brought for us, just put it on the table now, so that if it is very small then we will criticize you here and now before you go to sleep.' The subchief added, 'If it is indeed small, then we will pack you in your car right away ... without the cassava ... and off you go.'

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Human Relations Area Files

755 Prospect Street

New Haven, CT 06511

General Inquiries: ✉ hraf@yale.edu

Issues and Bugs: ✉ hraf-support@yale.edu



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